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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025
Third SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEENG201 –
READING CULTURE: FOOD, TRAVEL AND MUSIC

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Scheme of valuation

Part A
MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark.

1. b. Dark and Irony [CO1]
2. c. Sunday [CO1]
3. b. She gets older but never wiser [CO2]
4. c. Shared community uses [CO2]
5. d. Every trip can be a love affair [CO3]
6. a. Streets of Port-au-Prince in Haiti [CO3]
7. c. Cultural nostalgia [CO4]
8. a. Engineer [CO4]
9. b. Nottinghamshire [CO4]
10. b. The lingering grief of separation from the homeland [CO4]

(1x10=10)

Part B
SHORT ANSWER
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks.

11. Kicking coconut thrice symbolizes ritual belief - to dispel bad luck and ward off evil spirits - reveals deep-set customs rooted in the fear of the supernatural.
Note: Open to interpretation. Moderately lenient evaluation recommended. [CO1]
12. Thattukadas, Cafe Coffee Day, Quality Bakery: famous for Dutch Bruder bread - Kayees and Rahmatulla hotels: renowned for their special biriyani - Shanitulal S Mithaiwala: known for Gujarati snacks like khandvi and gatiya - Sarovaram: serves Onasadya. [CO1]
13. "Heal the World" reflects Michael Jackson's personal values of compassion, empathy, and a commitment to making the world a better place - emphasizes caring for vulnerable groups like children - advocates for peace, love, and social responsibility. [CO2]
14. Joan’s Rainbow in Salt N Pepper - how the narrative uses the baking of the cake by Kalidasan and Maya through exchanged notes without actually meeting - legend of a woman baking layers of a cake while awaiting her husband's return from war reflects themes of hope, love, and patience. [CO1]
15. Mongol Empire, under Grand Khan Kubla, controlled vast territories and ensured safe trade routes along the Silk Road - the Polos traveled through this empire, carrying valuable cargo and receiving royal protection for their journey – this stability enabled cultural and commercial exchanges across Eurasia during the 13th century. [CO3]

16. Paul Theroux prefers trains - allow closer observation of people and places, provide authentic experiences, and a slower pace for reflection - Theroux's childhood longing for train travel, sparked by growing up near railroad tracks, symbolizes a lifelong passion for exploration and discovery - nostalgia influences his approach to travel as an adventure, emphasizing the experience of the journey itself rather than the destination. [CO3]
17. Gulliver agreed cheerfully to be searched because he wanted to assure the Lilliputians of his good intentions and to gain their trust - understood their need for security and cooperated to show he was not a threat. [CO4]
18. Priests and lawyers acted as mediators and interpreters, facilitating communication between Gulliver and the Lilliputians - provided legitimacy and authority to the king's decisions regarding Gulliver. [CO4]
19. Special measures included tying Gulliver down strongly with ropes and chains, preparing a large wooden platform to carry him safely, and assigning many guards and servants to watch over him, ensuring he could not escape or harm anyone. [CO4]

(5x6=30)

Part C

ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks.

20. Childhood pivotal in shaping one's social identity - understanding of caste - "Recess" – children learn caste distinctions through everyday actions and play - reinforced by family and school environments - children's activities and peer interactions during recess reflect and perpetuate caste-based social order - caste is not just an adult practice but ingrained from childhood through socialisation and cultural norms.
    Note: Open to interpretation. Moderately lenient evaluation recommended. [CO1]
21. "Blowin' in the Wind" by Bob Dylan uses rhetorical questions to highlight the persistent social injustices and human suffering in the world - challenge the listener to think about issues like war, freedom, and empathy - phrase "The answer is blowin' in the wind" suggests that solutions to these problems are evident but often ignored or unacknowledged - poem critiques apathy and encourages awareness and action. [CO2]
22. Conversations with strangers enable genuine cultural exchange, broaden worldview, challenge preconceptions, and enrich understanding of local life, making travel transformative and memorable.
    Note: Open to interpretation. Moderately lenient evaluation recommended. [CO3]
23. A R Rahman's influence on Indian film music was transformative - debut for Roja blended Western and Carnatic classical music harmoniously without losing their identities - collaborations with directors such as Mani Ratnam and Shankar established new standards - Rahman's dedication to quality sound and innovation elevated film music quality, helping draw audiences to theatres, and continues to influence the industry profoundly. [CO4]

(15x2=30)